A FAMILY COOKBOOK

The Recipe Box

Transcribed from the original cards — newspaper clippings, typed sheets, and pages written by hand.



BREAKFAST · SUPPER · DESSERTS

THE RECIPE BOX

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Transcribed from the original cards — newspaper clippings, typed sheets, and pages written by hand. Family notes from the margins are kept in the cook's own voice.

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BREAKFAST

Swedish Pancakes

Thin, tender, and better if you wait. The batter wants a long rest — overnight if you can.

BREAKFAST

HANDWRITTEN CARD

Swedish Pancakes

A family skillet's worth · Batter rests 1 hour, preferably overnight

Ingredients

- 1 cup flour
- 1 cup table cream
- 1 cup milk
- ¼ tsp salt
- 3 eggs
- 3–5 Tbsp melted butter

From the card. For crispy pancakes, use a cast iron pan.

Method

01 Melt the butter and cool it slightly.

02 With an electric beater, beat the eggs and salt.

03 Add the milk and cream. Add the flour. Add the melted butter. Beat thoroughly for 2 minutes.

04 Cover the bowl with plastic wrap and chill for at least 1 hour, but preferably overnight.

05 To cook, heat the pan and lightly grease with shortening. Beat the pancake mix slightly to blend. Pour about ½ cup of mix into the pan and cook on medium heat until golden brown. Flip and cook the other side.



BREAKFAST

Jiffy Cinnamon Buns

Biscuit dough, brown-sugar butter, baked in muffin tins. Flip them out the moment they come from the oven.

BREAKFAST

CANADIAN LIVING, MAY 1989

Jiffy Cinnamon Buns

12 buns · 400°F · 15–20 minutes — watch them

Ingredients

DOUGH

- 2 cups flour
- 2 Tbsp sugar
- 4 tsp baking powder
- 1 tsp salt
- ¼ cup cold butter
- 1 cup milk (reduce just a bit)

TOPPING

- ⅓ cup butter, softened
- 1 cup packed brown sugar
- 1 Tbsp cinnamon
- ⅓ cup raisins

From the card. Roll out like a log, then seam under.

The usual way. I usually take them out after 15 minutes.

Method

01 Mix flour, sugar, baking powder, and salt. Blend in the cold butter until the mixture resembles coarse meal.

02 Pour in the milk, stirring lightly. Turn onto a floured surface and knead 8–10 times. Roll into a 12 × 8-inch rectangle.

03 Cream the butter, brown sugar, and cinnamon. Spread over the dough. Sprinkle with raisins.

04 Roll up jelly-roll style from the long side, seam under. Cut into 12 pieces. Place in greased muffin tins.

05 Bake at 400°F for 20 minutes. Watch the time — check after 15 minutes. Flip out immediately.



SUPPER

Peanut Chicken Stir Fry

Broiled chicken, a pan of steamed vegetables, rice cooked in broth — and the peanut-hoisin sauce served on the side, to drizzle.

Peanut Chicken Stir Fry

A large platter, family-style · Marinate 10 minutes; grill about 12 minutes

Ingredients

CHICKEN & RICE

- Chicken breasts, sliced into thin strips
- A little olive oil
- Salt and pepper
- Rice, cooked in chicken broth

SAUCE

- 1 cup chicken broth (or water)
- ½ cup peanut butter
- ⅔ cup hoisin sauce
- 4 Tbsp cider vinegar
- 2 garlic cloves, crushed
- Water, to thin if the sauce becomes too thick

VEGETABLES

- Broccoli, thinly sliced
- Celery, thinly sliced
- Carrots, thinly sliced
- Red pepper, thinly sliced

From the card. A little, little water — not much — to steam. Sauce stays on the side, for drizzling.

Method

01 Slice the chicken breasts into thin strips. Place in a bowl and toss with a little olive oil for at least 10 minutes. Place the chicken on a foil-lined sheet and season with salt and pepper.

02 Wash and cook the rice in chicken broth.

03 In a pot, mix the sauce — broth, peanut butter, hoisin, cider vinegar, and garlic — and simmer. Thin with water if it becomes too thick.

04 Turn the broiler to high and move the rack to the second rung.

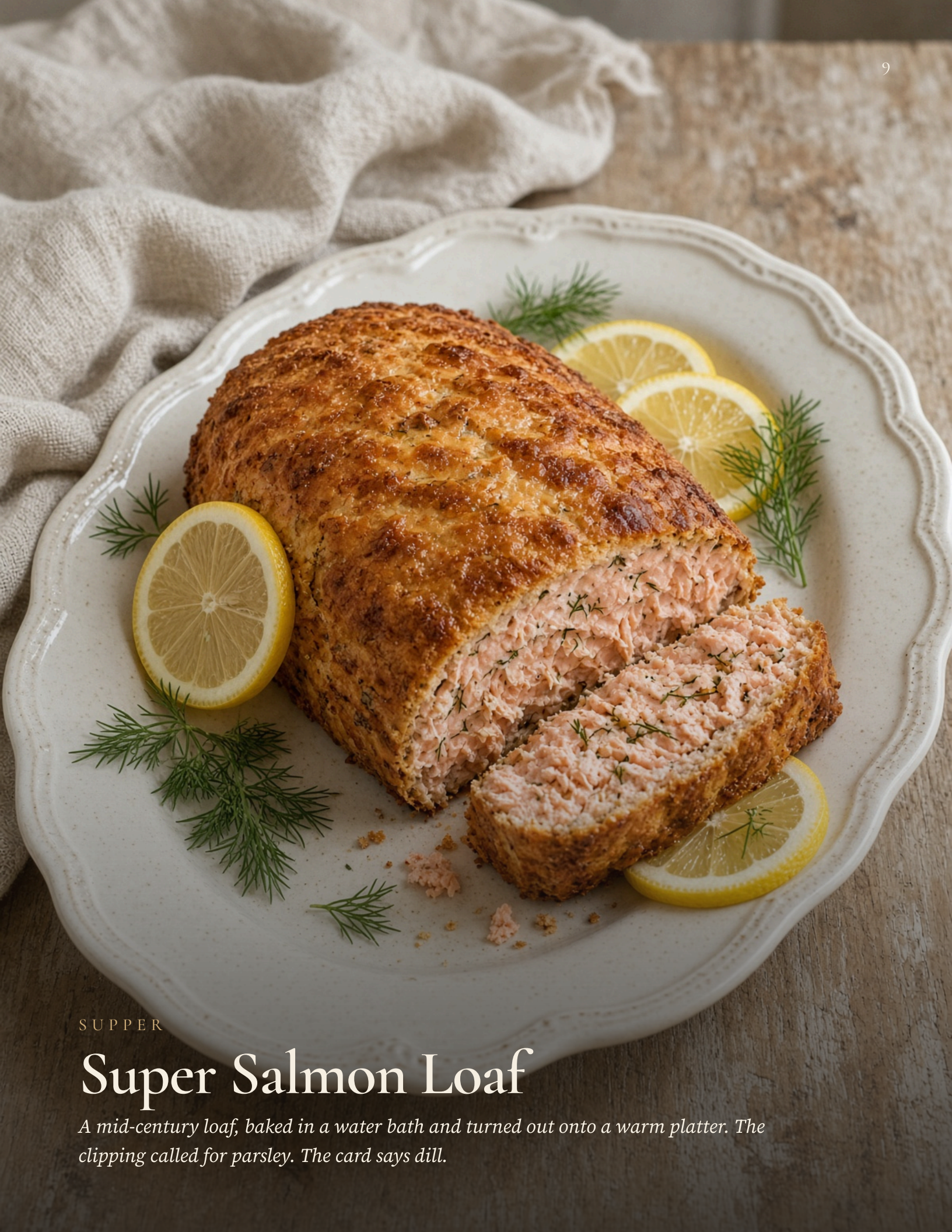
05 Wash and thinly slice the broccoli, celery, carrots, and red pepper.

06 Grill the chicken 6 minutes on one side. Flip and grill 6 minutes on the second side.

07 Cook the red peppers in hot oil in an electric fry pan. Then add the broccoli, carrots, and celery. Put on the lid. Add a little, little water (not much) to steam.

08 Put the rice on a large platter. Top with the vegetables and chicken.

09 Put the sauce in a separate bowl to drizzle over the vegetables and chicken.



SUPPER

Super Salmon Loaf

A mid-century loaf, baked in a water bath and turned out onto a warm platter. The clipping called for parsley. The card says dill.

SUPPER

NEWSPAPER CLIPPING

Super Salmon Loaf

6 servings · 350°F · 45–55 minutes, in a water bath

Ingredients

- 2 (7¾-ounce) cans salmon
- 4 tablespoons butter or margarine
- ¼ cup milk
- 1 cup unsalted cracker crumbs
- 3 medium eggs, separated
- 2 tablespoons chopped dill (the clipping said parsley)
- ¼ cup finely chopped onion
- 1 tablespoon lemon juice
- ½ teaspoon Worcestershire sauce
- ½ teaspoon salt
- ⅛ teaspoon pepper

Written in the margin. Dill — not parsley.

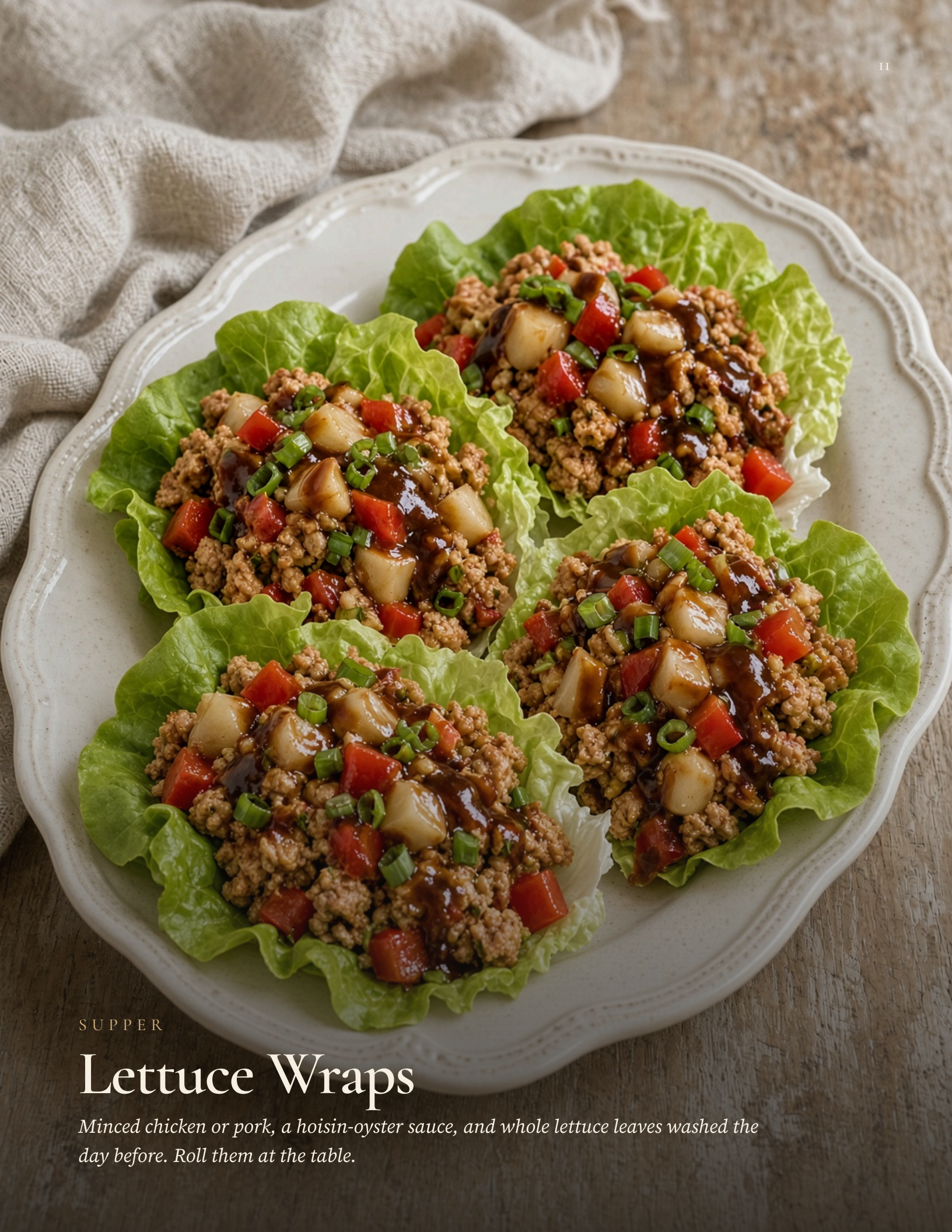
Method

01 Drain the salmon juices into a medium saucepan. Add the butter and milk to the salmon juice and heat just until the butter melts. Remove from heat; stir in the cracker crumbs and let stand five minutes.

02 Flake the salmon and fold into the crumb mixture along with the well-mashed bones. Beat the egg yolks and fold into the salmon mixture along with the remaining ingredients except the egg whites. Beat the egg whites until they form soft peaks. Fold into the salmon mixture.

03 Grease an 8½ × 4½-inch loaf pan and line with wax paper, leaving about an inch of paper to form a collar around the edges of the pan. Grease the paper. Pour the salmon mixture into the prepared pan and set in a shallow baking pan. Pour boiling water into the baking pan to a depth of one inch.

04 Bake in a moderate oven, 350°F, for 45 to 55 minutes. Remove the pan from the water. Let stand for five minutes before unmoulding onto a heated platter. Garnish with lemon slices.



SUPPER

Lettuce Wraps

Minced chicken or pork, a hoisin-oyster sauce, and whole lettuce leaves washed the day before. Roll them at the table.

Lettuce Wraps

Lettuce cups, to share · Lettuce washed and chilled the day before

Ingredients

FILLING

- Whole lettuce leaves
- 5 cloves garlic, minced
- 2 large green onions, minced
- 1 whole red pepper, minced
- A chunk of fresh ginger, minced
- 1 carrot, minced
- 1 small can water chestnuts, minced
- 1 pound chicken or pork, minced
- Olive oil
- Salt and pepper
- A handful of steamed noodles

SAUCE

- 3 tablespoons hoisin sauce
- ½ cup oyster sauce
- 1 tablespoon sesame oil
- 1 tablespoon sugar

The day before. Wash and chill the leaves. Separate each one.

In the margin. Hoisin is 3 tablespoons, with "¾ cup + 1 Tbsp" written beside it.

Method

01 Prepare all the ingredients and the sauce ahead of cooking.

02 Have whole lettuce leaves washed and chilled the day before. When washing, separate each leaf individually.

03 Mince the garlic, green onions, red pepper, ginger, carrot, and water chestnuts.

04 Make the sauce by combining the hoisin, oyster sauce, sesame oil, and sugar in a bowl. Stir to mix.

05 Heat olive oil in a fry pan over medium heat. Gently cook the garlic, onions, red pepper, ginger, carrot, and water chestnuts.

06 Add 1 pound of minced chicken or pork. Stir to break it up and cook until cooked through. Season with salt and pepper. Add the sauce to the meat mixture. Just before serving, add a handful of steamed noodles.

07 Spoon into lettuce cups. Drizzle with hoisin. Eat and roll up.



SUPPER

Oriental Meatballs

Gingersnap meatballs baked, then finished in a ketchup and pineapple sauce. The clipping says soy sauce twice. The margin says to add it carefully, in the sauce.

SUPPER

NEWSPAPER CLIPPING

Oriental Meatballs

6 servings · 24 meatballs · 350°F · 10 minutes, then 10–15 more in the sauce

Ingredients

MEATBALLS

- 1½ pounds lean ground beef
- 1 cup fine-crushed gingersnaps
- 1 medium egg
- 2 tablespoons soy sauce
- 1 (398 mL) can crushed pineapple, drained well, syrup reserved
- 1 teaspoon salt
- 1 teaspoon dry mustard
- ¼ teaspoon pepper
- ¼ teaspoon garlic powder

SAUCE

- ¾ cup ketchup
- ¼ cup soy sauce
- ½ teaspoon ground ginger
- 1½ teaspoons dry mustard
- 1 tablespoon brown sugar
- ⅓ cup pineapple syrup
- Cooked rice, for serving

Written beside the soy sauce. Add the soy sauce carefully, in the sauce portion.

In the margin. Add honey to the sauce. Garlic. Use cookie crumb — blend till very fine.

Method

MEATBALLS

01 Combine the beef, gingersnap crumbs, egg, soy sauce, crushed pineapple, salt, mustard, pepper, and garlic powder.

02 Form into 24 meatballs, about 1½ inches across. Place in a shallow baking pan.

03 Bake at 350°F for 10 minutes.

SAUCE

04 Combine the ketchup, soy sauce, ginger, mustard, brown sugar, and pineapple syrup.

05 Pour over the meatballs and continue baking 10 to 15 minutes longer.

06 Serve over hot rice.



DESSERTS

Smack Cake

A crumbly butter base and a coconut meringue top. The card is very clear about the coconut: stir, do not beat.

DESSERTS

TYPED CARD

Smack Cake

One 8 × 8 pan · 350°F · 25–30 minutes

Ingredients

BASE

- 1½ cups flour
- 1 tsp baking powder
- ½ cup white sugar
- ½ cup melted butter
- 2 egg yolks, beaten slightly
- 1 tsp vanilla

TOPPING

- 2 egg whites
- ¼ tsp salt
- 1 cup brown sugar
- 1 cup medium unsweetened coconut

Very important. Stir in the coconut — do not beat.

Method

BASE

01 Set the oven at 350°F.

02 Lightly grease an 8 × 8 baking pan, or line it with foil for easy removal.

03 Mix the dry ingredients.

04 Mix together the egg yolks and vanilla.

05 Combine the dry ingredients, egg, and melted butter to form a crumbly mixture.

06 Pat the mixture fairly firmly into the prepared pan.

TOPPING

07 Beat the egg whites until they are stiff.

08 Add the salt and sugar and beat again.

09 Stir in (very important to stir, not beat) the coconut.

10 Gently spread the topping onto the base layer.

11 Bake at 350°F for 25–30 minutes.

12 Cool on a rack.